

Product Positioning

Product Category

The Award Nomination App is an AI-enabled employee recognition governance platform.

It sits between:

- Employee recognition tools.
- HR workflow automation.
- Fraud and integrity analytics.
- Payroll coordination.
- Executive HR analytics.

Positioning Statement

For organizations that need trusted employee recognition programs, the Award Nomination App provides a tenant-configurable award nomination, approval, integrity monitoring, analytics, and payroll coordination platform. Unlike simple recognition portals or generic workflow tools, it combines workflow automation, fraud-aware review, graph analytics, auditability, multilingual tenant configuration, and Azure-native operations in one SaaS-ready system.

Target Customers

Best-fit customers include:

- Mid-market and enterprise organizations with monetary recognition programs.
- HR teams managing award budgets across departments or geographies.
- Organizations concerned about fairness, favoritism, or inconsistent award practices.
- Companies using Microsoft Entra ID and Azure.
- Organizations that need payroll-connected bonus awards.
- Grant, nonprofit, public sector, or regulated organizations requiring auditability.

Buyer Personas

Persona	Buying motivation
CHRO or HR leader	Improve recognition fairness, governance, and employee engagement.
Total rewards leader	Control award spend and integrate payouts with payroll.
Compliance or risk leader	Reduce abuse risk and improve traceability.
CIO or CTO	Adopt a tenant-ready Azure-native platform with identity and observability.
Finance leader	Forecast award budget needs and track payout status.
Business unit executive	Understand recognition patterns and team-level trends.

Core Pain Points

- Recognition programs are manual, inconsistent, or opaque.
- Monetary awards can be overused, duplicated, or concentrated among select groups.
- Approvals lack analytics and auditability.
- HR teams cannot easily identify reciprocal nomination patterns or nomination rings.
- Payroll execution is disconnected from approval.
- Executives lack live visibility into spend, risk, and forecasted review load.
- Multilingual or region-specific configuration is difficult in generic tools.

Differentiators

Differentiator	Why it matters
Tenant-configurable SaaS model	Supports multiple customer organizations without separate codebases.
Fraud-aware workflow	Integrity screening happens before manager approval, not after damage is done.
HRBP review queue	Keeps humans in control of high-risk decisions.
Graph pattern detection	Finds collusion and structural anomalies that row-level rules miss.
Semantic description checks	Detects duplicate, low-fit, transactional, or low-quality nomination text.
Payroll broker	Connects award approval to payout operations.
AI analytics workspace	Lets admins ask questions and investigate patterns from system data.
Azure-native deployment	Fits enterprise Microsoft environments and security expectations.
Observability built in	Supports real operational support and enterprise due diligence.

Competitive Alternatives

Alternative	Product advantage
Spreadsheets and email	Provides workflow, auditability, automation, and analytics.
Generic workflow tools	Adds tenant-aware recognition semantics, fraud scoring, HRBP review, and payout orchestration.
Employee recognition platforms	Adds governance, integrity analytics, graph detection, and payroll-aware payout handling.
BI dashboards over HR data	Adds operational workflow and decision routing, not just reporting.
Custom internal app	Provides reusable SaaS architecture, deployment automation, and productized roadmap.

Packaging Opportunities

Package	Capabilities
Core Recognition	Nominations, manager approvals, tenant branding, email notifications, history.
Governance	HRBP review, audit logs, impersonation, rejection reasons, tenant policy controls.
Integrity Analytics	Fraud scoring, graph findings, semantic checks, alerts, exports.
Executive Analytics	Dashboards, trends, diversity metrics, forecasts, AI ask/investigate.
Payroll Connected	Payroll broker, provider setup, payout status, payroll failure support.
Enterprise	Multi-region Azure deployment, advanced tenant onboarding, compliance documentation, custom integrations.

Relationship to Integrity Sentinel

The Award Nomination App is a domain-specific integrity product. Integrity Sentinel can become the broader platform layer for detecting risk patterns across domains such as:

- HR recognition.
- Payroll adjustments.
- Procurement approvals.
- Expense reimbursements.
- Grant awards.
- Access requests.
- Vendor onboarding.

The Award Nomination App provides a practical proof point for the larger platform story: workflow + risk analytics + human review + audit + AI investigation.